

Internet, WWW and Browser — Detailed Lecture Notes

JKSSB Computer Awareness

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34.1 The Internet: the network itself

The Internet is a global network of connected computers and networks. It is best described as a **network of networks**: smaller networks joined together so that any connected device can reach any other. It carries many services — the World Wide Web, e-mail, file transfer, and more. The Internet is the physical infrastructure underneath all of these: the cables, routers, servers, and the devices connected to them.

Definition (Internet). *The global network of interconnected computers and networks over which services such as the Web and e-mail run.*

Term	Meaning in this lesson
Internet	The global network of networks; the infrastructure.
WWW (World Wide Web)	A service on the Internet: linked web pages and sites.
Website	A collection of related webpages under one address.
Webpage	A single document on the Web, shown in a browser.
Homepage	The main or starting page of a website.
Browser	Software that opens and displays websites and webpages.
Search engine	A website that finds other pages matching typed keywords.
Client	The device or program that requests a service or resource.
Server	The computer or program that supplies services to clients.
ISP (Internet Service Provider)	The company or organisation that provides the Internet connection.
Hyperlink	Clickable text or image that jumps to another page or section.
URL (Uniform Resource Locator)	The address of a webpage or resource on the Web.

The rest of this lesson uses these terms in one consistent sense. The **Internet** is the network. The **WWW** is the linked-pages service running on that network. A **webpage** is one document, a **website** is the collection, and the **homepage** is the collection's front door. A **browser** opens pages; a **search engine** finds pages. A **client** requests and a **server** supplies. An **ISP** provides the connection itself. A **hyperlink** points to another page, and a **URL** is a page's address.

34.2 Internet vs WWW

The single most tested confusion in this lesson is Internet versus WWW. The Internet is the whole global network; the WWW — World Wide Web — is one service that runs on the Internet, namely

the system of linked web pages and sites. E-mail is another service on the same Internet, and it is not part of the Web. Access follows the same layering: a device reaches the Internet through an ISP connection, and it reaches the Web through a browser running over that Internet connection.

Definition (World Wide Web (WWW)). *The system of linked web pages and websites accessed over the Internet through a browser; one service among several that the Internet carries.*

Example 34.2.1. *An item states, “The Internet and the World Wide Web are the same thing.” This is wrong. The Internet is the global network of networks, while the WWW is one service running on it. The wrong option has collapsed the infrastructure and one of its services into a single term.*

34.3 Website, webpage, and homepage

A **webpage** is a single document on the Web, shown inside a browser. A **website** is a collection of related webpages grouped under one address (domain). The **homepage** is the main or starting page of a website — the page that loads when the site’s base address is typed. In order of size: the homepage is one page, any single document is a webpage, and the whole collection is the website.

Definition (Website, webpage, homepage). *A webpage is one document on the Web; a website is the collection of related webpages under one address; the homepage is the website’s main or starting page.*

Each webpage of a website has its own URL, and the homepage URL is the site’s base address. Typing that address in the browser’s address bar loads the homepage first, and hyperlinks on it lead to the site’s remaining pages.

34.4 Browser

A **browser** is software used to open and view websites and webpages. It sends a request for a page and displays the page that comes back. Common browsers are Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Microsoft Edge, and Apple Safari. A browser is software installed on the user’s device; it is not the Internet itself, and it is not a search engine.

Definition (Browser). *Software that requests webpages and displays them; examples are Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Microsoft Edge, and Apple Safari.*

34.5 Search engine

A **search engine** is a website (a service) that finds other webpages matching keywords typed by the user. Examples are Google, Bing, and Yahoo. It is reached *through* a browser: the browser is the tool open on the device, and the search-engine site is loaded inside it. Searching therefore needs both layers — a browser open on the device, and a search-engine site loaded in that browser.

Definition (Search engine). *A website that returns the pages matching a user’s keywords; examples are Google, Bing, and Yahoo.*

The browser-versus-search-engine table is worth memorising as a whole. A browser is software (an application) whose role is to open and display pages; a search engine is a website whose role is to find pages for keywords. Chrome, Firefox, Edge, and Safari belong in the first column; Google, Bing, and Yahoo belong in the second. The classic trap swaps them: it calls Chrome a search engine or Google a browser.

34.6 Client and server

A **client** is the device or program that requests a service or resource. The office PC's browser asking for a webpage is acting as a client: it asks, and it does not supply the page itself. A **server** is the computer (or program) that supplies services or resources to clients. A web server stores websites and sends pages to the browsers that ask for them. One server can serve many clients at the same time, and servers stay switched on and connected so that clients can reach them at any time.

Definition (Client and server). *The client requests a service or resource; the server supplies it. On the Web, the browser is the client and the web server holds the pages.*

The two always appear as a pair, in three steps. First, the client (the browser) sends a request for a page. Second, the server receives the request and sends the page back. Third, the browser displays the received page. This request-and-response pair is the client-server model of the Web: typing a site address and pressing Enter sends a request, the site's server returns the homepage, and the browser shows it.

34.7 ISP: the connection provider

ISP stands for Internet Service Provider. It is the company or organisation that provides the Internet connection to homes and offices. Without an ISP connection, the device cannot reach the Internet at all, so the ISP link comes before everything else: no ISP means no browsing, no search, and no e-mail. This is the tested fact of WO 2026 Q74 (PYQ-34): ISP expands to Internet Service Provider, and no other expansion is accepted.

Definition (ISP (Internet Service Provider)). *The company or organisation that provides the Internet connection to homes and offices.*

34.8 Hyperlink and URL

A **hyperlink** (link) is clickable text or an image that jumps to another page or section. Clicking it loads the linked webpage, which may sit on the same site or on a different one. Links are what make the Web a “web”: pages joined to pages. Note the division of labour: a hyperlink points the way, and the browser follows it when clicked.

A **URL** — Uniform Resource Locator — is the address of a webpage or resource on the Web. Typing the site's URL in the browser's address bar loads its homepage. The URL names the page; the hyperlink jumps to it.

Definition (Hyperlink and URL). *A hyperlink is clickable text or an image that leads to another page; a URL (Uniform Resource Locator) is the address of a webpage or resource.*

34.9 Full-form ladder of this lesson

Direct-recall full-form items are among the most common JKSSB computer formats, so learn each expansion exactly and give the full form on first mention. **ISP** — Internet Service Provider — gives the Internet connection. **WWW** — World Wide Web — is the linked system of pages and sites. **URL** — Uniform Resource Locator — is the address of a page or resource. **HTTP** — HyperText Transfer Protocol — is the set of rules browsers and servers follow when requesting and delivering pages. **HTML** — HyperText Markup Language — is the language in which webpages are written.

34.10 Exam retrieval and common confusions

Five distinctions prevent most errors on this topic.

1. The Internet is **not** the Web; the WWW is **one service** running on the Internet.
2. A browser is **not** a search engine. Chrome is a **browser**; Google is a **search engine**.
3. A website is the **collection**; a webpage is **one document**; the homepage is the **first page**.
4. The client **requests** and the server **supplies**. The ISP — Internet Service Provider — gives the connection (PYQ-34).
5. A hyperlink **points**; the browser **opens**. A URL is the page's address.

Example 34.10.1. *An item asks which software is used to view websites. Trace the roles: the browser opens and displays pages, while the search engine finds pages and the ISP provides the connection. The answer is the browser (for example Chrome). If the stem instead asks which site finds pages for keywords, the answer is the search engine (for example Google), and if it asks who provides the connection, the answer is the ISP.*

Exercises

1. Distinguish the Internet from the World Wide Web.
2. Distinguish a website from a webpage and from a homepage.
3. Distinguish a browser from a search engine, giving two examples of each.
4. Explain the roles of client, server, and ISP when a page is opened.
5. Define hyperlink and URL, and explain how the two work together.

Solutions

1. The Internet is the global network of networks — the infrastructure. The WWW (World Wide Web) is one service running on that infrastructure: the system of linked web pages and sites.
2. A webpage is one document on the Web; a website is the collection of related webpages under one address; the homepage is the website's main or starting page.
3. A browser is software that opens and displays pages (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari). A search engine is a website that finds pages for keywords (Google, Bing, Yahoo); it is reached through a browser.
4. The client (browser) requests the page, the server (web server) supplies it, and the ISP (Internet Service Provider) provides the Internet connection over which the request and response travel.
5. A hyperlink is clickable text or an image that jumps to another page; a URL (Uniform Resource Locator) is a page's address. Clicking the hyperlink tells the browser to load the page named by that URL.